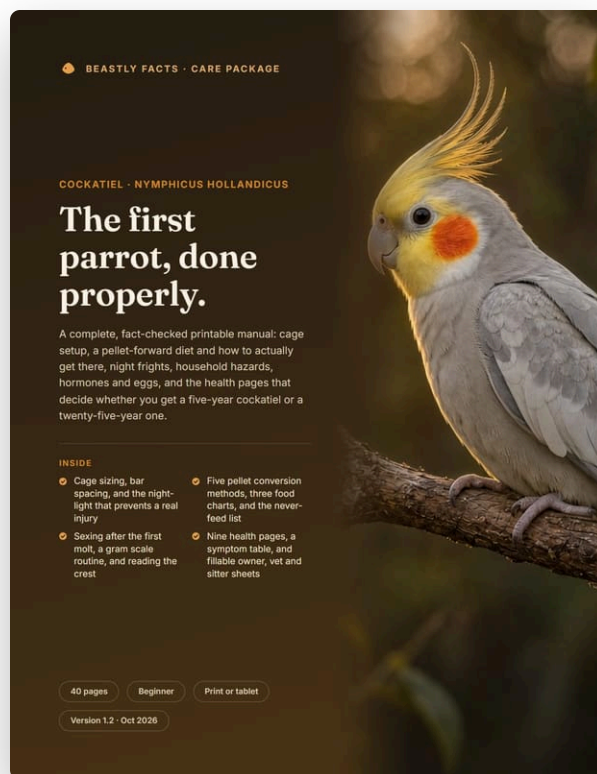


FREE SAMPLE

Cockatiel Care Package

The first 4 pages of the 40-page printable manual, free to keep.



In this sample: What's inside, How to Use This Package, Quick Profile & Cost Overview. The contents page shows every one of the 40 pages, so you can see exactly what the full package covers before you buy it.

Not in this sample: the 36 pages that follow, which are the full care guide, the health section, the quick reference cards, and the owner tools, checklists and logs.

The full package is \$8.99 at beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/cockatiel/. One purchase, and every corrected edition is a free re-download from your library. The free cockatiel care guide it was built from is at beastlyfacts.com/guides/cockatiel/, and stays free.

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What's inside

Every page is written to be used, not just read once.

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START HERE

How to use this package

Three ways to get value from it, depending on where you are right now.

If you haven't bought a bird yet

Read pages 4 through 12 in order before buying anything. Two decisions cost the most to undo: the cage on page 5, which people buy small and replace inside a year, and whether you bring home one cockatiel or two on page 9, which decides how tame the bird becomes and how much of your evening it needs. Settle both, then use the Budget and Shopping List on page 30 to buy once instead of twice.

If your cockatiel is already home

Start with the Setup Checklist on page 28 to audit what you have, then page 10 if the bird is on a seed mix. Diet is the single biggest lever on how long a cockatiel lives, and the conversion takes weeks or months, so starting it today matters more than finishing this book first. Then page 7, because a night light costs almost nothing and prevents the one injury this species is famous for. If anything looks wrong, go straight to Health Red Flags on page 19.

Print these first

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Page 28: Setup Checklist & Targets | ☐ Page 35: Pet-Sitter Sheet |
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WHY THIS PACKAGE EXISTS

The cockatiel is sold as the easy, gentle, cheap first parrot, and most of that is true. What follows from it is not: a lot of the care advice still in circulation was written for a bird nobody expected to keep for twenty years. A seed bowl, a tall narrow cage bought for its looks, and a bedroom that stays dark and silent all night are all still normal advice somewhere, and all three shorten the bird's life or injure it. Every figure here is cross-checked against veterinary sources, listed on page 39, and every temperature and dimension is given in both imperial and metric.

NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR

An avian veterinarian. This is a husbandry reference for day-to-day care. Anything urgent or health-related is a professional call, not a page in this book. Cockatiels hide illness until they are genuinely sick, and at 90 g the margin afterwards is hours, not days. Find a vet before you need one and write the number on page 29.

SECTION 01

Quick profile

Everything at a glance before you read the detail.

Scientific name	<i>Nymphicus hollandicus</i> . The smallest member of the cockatoo family, and the only species in its genus
Adult size	About 12.5 in (32 cm) head to tail tip. Roughly half of that is tail
Adult weight	80 to 125 g, average about 90 g. Your bird's own stable baseline matters more than the range. Page 16
Captive lifespan	12 to 15 years typically, with up to 25 reported. The gap is almost entirely diet and veterinary care: page 10 and page 20
Native range	Inland Australia. Nomadic flocks that follow water and seeding grasses
Diet type	Grass-seed eater in the wild, kept on a pellet-forward diet in captivity. Page 10
Cage floor, one bird	20×20 in (51×51 cm) as the floor. Width beats height: a cockatiel flies in short horizontal bursts
Cage target	24×24×30 in (61×61×76 cm) or wider. Page 5 explains why the sources differ
Bar spacing	1/2 in (13 mm) is the safe figure. Page 5 on why some sources allow more
Room temperature	70 to 80°F (21 to 27°C). Drafts and sudden swings matter more than the number
Darkness needed	10 to 12 hours, uninterrupted, every night, with a dim night light. Page 7
Body temperature	About 107.1°F (41.8°C). Resting heart rate about 206 beats per minute, breathing 40 to 50 a minute
Sexual maturity	6 to 12 months
Sexing	Visible in the normal gray after the first molt, one of the few parrots where looking at the bird is enough. Page 16
Handling difficulty	Beginner. Built on trust with a flighted bird, never on restraint. Page 14
Conservation status	Least Concern, rated by the IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature), which keeps the global list of threatened species

Cost overview

Initial setup

The bird runs \$75 to \$250 depending on the color mutation, with normal gray usually cheapest because it is the wild type and needs no selective breeding. A complete first setup lands most buyers at **\$320 to \$860**, and the cage is routinely the biggest single line, often more than the bird. Page 30 itemizes it.

Ongoing

Food, toys and cage upkeep run roughly **\$200 to \$350 a year**, and the annual exam takes that to **\$285 to \$550**, about \$24 to \$46 a month. An avian exam alone is \$85 to \$200 before any testing, and a reproductive emergency runs \$300 to \$800 or more. Bird insurance barely exists, so the emergency fund is you. Page 30 itemizes both.

THE NUMBER THAT SHOULD DRIVE THE DECISION

Not the price. The lifespan. A cockatiel bought for a ten-year-old is very likely still alive when that child finishes college, and the commonest reason one does not reach fifteen is a seed bowl nobody ever changed. If you are not prepared to still be feeding this bird in 2046, buy something else.

THE ONE THING THIS SPECIES IS FAMOUS FOR

Night frights. A cockatiel startled in total darkness thrashes violently inside the cage and can injure a wing, a foot or its face on the bars before you reach the light switch. It is the single most preventable injury in this book, and the fix is a dim night light. Page 7.